

Special Notice (SN) DARPA-SN-26-04: BTO Innovation Opportunity (BIO) Fair

DATE: November 12, 2025

LOCATION: Hilton Arlington Rosslyn The Key, 1900 Fort Myer Dr, Arlington, VA 22209

REGISTRATION DEADLINE: **October 31, 2025, 11:59 PM ET** or until capacity (350 in-person participants and 350 virtual participants) is reached, whichever comes first.

REGISTRATION WEBSITE: <https://events.sa-meetings.com/BIOFair2025>

TECHNICAL POC: Dr. Michael Koeris, DARPA/BTO

Email: BIOFair@darpa.mil

The Biological Technologies Office (BTO) of the Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency (DARPA) will host the BTO Innovation Opportunity Fair (BIO Fair) event for prospective proposers on November 12, 2025, in Arlington, Virginia. Advance registration is required for in-person and virtual event. There will be no on-site registration. The event will include overview presentations by DARPA personnel, including BTO Program Managers.

Note: all times listed in this announcement, the agenda, and on the registration website are in Eastern Time.

Through hosting the BIO Fair event, BTO aims to: (1) familiarize participants with BTO's mission and interest areas; (2) facilitate discussions with potential proposers; (3) increase the efficiency of proposal preparation and evaluation; and (4) foster a new performer network.

This meeting will be held at the Unclassified level. All in-person attendees are required to present government-issued photo identification upon entry to the event.

Biological Technologies Office Overview:

BTO seeks innovative ideas to develop novel capabilities for national security. BTO's strategic thrust areas can be found here: <https://www.darpa.mil/about/offices/bto>.

There are two mechanisms for sharing novel concepts with BTO outside of targeted program announcements.

The first is through the Office-Wide BAA:

<https://sam.gov/opp/8d403582edfd409795560247e8d229b7/view>. BTO is interested in a broad array of topics that include such disparate areas as artificial intelligence, machine learning, combat casualty care, human performance, materials, sensors, processing, agriculture, security, safety, surveillance, biomedical and biodefense. Please review the Office-Wide BAA for more details.

The second is through two [Enduring Topic Areas](#) found on the Expedited Research Innovation System (ERIS), which enables BTO to promote participation by new or non-traditional submitters. ERIS is a tool to present revolutionary technologies, capabilities, and research to DARPA in an environment with a rapid acquisition, Other Transaction-based pathway. The ERIS Master Solicitation can be found here:

<https://sam.gov/opp/1e287185b7694348881c2d99dcf0e8bf/view>

The Enduring Topic Areas are:

- Advanced technologies for defense against potential chemical and biological threats, human-made or naturally occurring. This topic supports technologies for defense of humans and elements of the bioeconomy critical to national security, including agricultural crops, livestock, and biomanufacturing production organisms that deliver threat surveillance, threat detection, threat diagnosis, countermeasure design, countermeasure deployment, and threat attribution, to include simulation-based and experiment-based technologies.
- Advanced technologies for the improved resilience of US operations throughout the prepare, deployment, execute, and return cycle. This topic supports technologies for human health and performance optimization. This topic supports biotechnologies for production of supplies, in situ resource utilization, and creation of operational advantages, including in austere locations. This topic supports technologies in the convergence of Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning (AI/ML) with chemistry and biology, including foundation models and data factories.

Registration Information:

The BIO Fair will be held in Arlington, Virginia on November 12, 2025 at the Hilton Arlington Rosslyn The Key, located at 1900 Fort Myer Drive, Arlington, VA 22209. The registration fee is \$150 for all in-person attendees (standard and U.S. Military or U.S. Government Personnel) and no registration fee for virtual attendees. Attendance is open to individuals who are U.S. citizens, U.S. permanent residents, and foreign nationals. In person registration is limited to three (3) people per entity and maximum venue capacity is limited to 350 participants. Virtual registration is limited to 350 participants. Early registration for both in person and virtual attendance is strongly recommended.

There will be no on-site registration. Advance registration is required.

Please register at <https://events.sa-meetings.com/BIOFair2025> no later than October 31, 2025, at 11:59 p.m. ET. Late registrations may be accepted after all pre-registered attendees are admitted, if room capacity allows. Note that late registration processing requires significant coordination and may not be completed in time to attend the BIO Fair event.

All meeting registrants who are not U.S. Citizens must complete and submit one of the following:

- All U.S. Permanent Residents and Foreign Nationals not representing a foreign government must submit a DARPA Form 60 “U.S. Permanent Resident and Foreign National Visit Request”, which can be submitted via the following link: <https://dtsn.darpa.mil/eform60/>. Form 60 submission instructions are provided on the registration website and in the registration confirmation email.
- Foreign government personnel who are representing a foreign government in an official capacity must submit an official Foreign Visit Request (FVR) via their respective Embassy based in Washington, DC. Contact your Embassy staff for assistance in submitting the Official Visit Request.

Failure to complete and submit the required forms prior to **November 5, 2025**, may result in the cancellation of existing registration. Please contact BTO_Security@darpa.mil for any further questions about the security process.

Disclaimers:

This Special Notice is issued solely for information and program planning purposes and does not constitute a formal solicitation for proposals or proposal abstracts; any so sent will be disregarded. In accordance with FAR 15.201(e), responses to this Special Notice are not offers and cannot be accepted by the Government to form a binding contract. Attendance is strictly voluntary and is not required to propose to subsequent Announcements (if any) or Solicitations (if any) on this topic. DARPA will not provide reimbursement for costs incurred in responding to this Special Notice. Respondents are advised that DARPA is under no obligation to acknowledge receipt of any information received or provide feedback to respondents with respect to any information submitted under this Special Notice.

No classified, ITAR controlled, or proprietary information shall be presented or discussed at the BIO Fair event.

Questions may be addressed to BIOFair@darpa.mil.